the agents and touts of SSNCo was to use the tom-tom to catch the attention of prospective customers. Waller, in an unprecedented manner, invoked provisions (Section 166) of the Criminal Procedure Code to prohibit this—a move BI was only too glad to welcome.[57]

In describing 'the vagaries of a Tuticorin Magistrate', *India* (and *Swadesamitran*) drew a parallel with the activities of J.B. Fuller, notorious for his repression of the Swadeshi movement as lieutenant governor of Eastern Bengal.[58] Bharati, tongue in cheek, expressed the hope that the news of the liberal John Morley having succeeded John Brodrick as secretary of state for India may have reached far-off Tuticorin,[59] and excoriated English officials for biting the hand that feeds them.[60] Even though Waller was soon transferred, it did not spell the end of trouble.

There were of course rare exceptions such as Captain Carlean, port officer, who reprimanded a BI clerk for demanding favours: 'You and a beggar on the street are the same to me.' His subsequent transfer to Masulipatnam—one is not sure if this was punishment for his fair behaviour—was mourned by the Swadeshis.[61] As noted earlier, a fair-minded VOC mentioned in court that Sub-Magistrate G.T.H. Bracken too had acted in a non-partisan manner.[62]

As the district superintendent of police, putting on a tone of injured innocence, noted, 'The officials have been, and are being, accused of deliberately obstructing the company in the interest of the BI and this is really believed to be true by perfectly loyal and well-intentioned natives of education throughout India.'[63]

Such was the popular feeling against the British company that local people took great joy when ill-luck struck supporters of BI. They rejoiced when news came that a trader who shipped on the British steamer had fractured his arm when a huge sack accidentally fell on him, and another anti-Swadeshi trader made huge losses in his business.[64]